
MEETING MINUTES

The First Regular Meeting of the Medford School Committee

January 8, 2024

Regular Meeting: 6:00 p.m.

- I. Roll Call for Attendance of Members and Student Representatives - **7/0 present**

Student Representatives - None

- II. Salute the Flag

III. School Committee Reorganization

- Election of Vice-Chair

Member Branley to elect Member Graham, Roll Call Vote - 7/0 approved

- Election of Secretary

Member Olapade to elect Member Ruseau, Roll Call Vote - 7/0 approved

- IV. Good of the Order

- Outline for committees was sent by Member Graham to all members.
- Look at results and then review the outcome at another meeting and vote on it.
- Outline first, second and third choices to the Mayor.
- Member McLaughlin - school committee goals review to be put on the agenda for the first meeting in February. Send goals to new members.

- V. Consent Agenda

Motion to sever by Member Reinfeld, second by Member Graham - 7/0 approved

- Bills and Payrolls

Motion to approve by Member McLaughlin, Second by Member Reinfeld - 7/0 approved

- Regular School Committee Minutes, **December 18, 2023**

Motion to approve as amended by Member Reinfeld to correct name spelling, second by Member McLaughlin - 7/0 approved

- VI. Report of Subcommittees - None

- VII. Report of the Superintendent

1. **Superintendent's Updates and Comments** - Dr. Marice Edouard-Vincent, Superintendent
2. **Leadership for Social Change Pre-College Program: Accessibility to Performing Arts** - Teagan Mustone, MHS Graduate 2023
3. **School Update** - Roberts Elementary School by Principal Michelle Crowell
4. **Recommendation to Approve** a donation from the Consulate General of Italy for \$4,851.77 for the Italian language program.

Motion to approve by Member McLaughlin, second by Member Graham - 7/0 approved

5. **Recommendation to Approve** a donation of classroom supplies to all Medford Public Schools (estimated value of \$1,200.00) by Elizabeth Cronin in memory of her mother Elinor Cronin, a former teacher at Medford High School.

Motion to approve by Member Reinfeld, second by Member Graham - 6/0/1 approved

6. **Revised Superintendent's Evaluation Goals (SY 2023-2024)** - Dr. Marice Edouard-Vincent, Superintendent

Member Graham offers amendment to #12 concerned there is no way for the Administration to accomplish this in light of MSBA work understandably.

Member McLaughlin appreciates the concern, but at the same time suggests having a subcommittee look at this not expecting the Administration to roll it out.

Motion to approve as amended by Member Graham to table #12 regarding the Superintendent's Strategic Plan, second by Member Ruseau - 7/0 approved

7. **Recommendation to Approve SY 24-25 School Calendar**- Dr. Peter Cushing, Assistant Superintendent of Enrichment, Innovation, and Operations

Motion to approve Calendar A by Member Ruseau, second by Member McLaughlin - 7/0 approved

Motion by Member Ruseau for a Committee of the Whole Meeting to discuss Calendars B and C as possible future schedule, second by Member McLaughlin - 6/1 approved

Presentations of the Public - None

VIII. Continued Business - None

IX. New Business

2024-01 Offered by Member Graham

Whereas the Medford Public Schools recognizes the vital role of play in the development and well-being of our students;

Whereas the current playground facilities at McGlynn Elementary are in need of replacement to create a safe and fun environment that meets the growing and diverse needs of our student body; and

Whereas the creation of a new, inclusive, and engaging playground is a priority for the enhancement of our educational environment. Now, therefore, be it:

Resolved, that the Medford School Committee:

1. establishes the McGlynn Playground Replacement Initiative and Donation Campaign pursuant to policy FF - Policy for Dedication and Naming of School Buildings, Facilities, and Grounds; and
2. requests the administration establish a mechanism to account for and report on the donations; and
3. requests the administration set up a public relations campaign to solicit donations to the playground fund to offset the costs of replacing the playground. The promotion of the initiative will occur through school newsletters, local media, social media, and community events. The campaign will have the following objectives and donation tier structure

Objective:

To raise funds for the construction of a new playground at McGlynn Elementary that fosters a safe, inclusive, and stimulating environment for all students.

Donation Tier Structure:

- "Hopscotch Hero" Tier (Donations of \$50 - \$249)
- "Swing Set Superstar" Tier (Donations of \$250 - \$499)
- "Slide Savant" Tier (Donations of \$500 - \$999)
- "Climbing Frame Champion" Tier (Donations of \$1,000 - \$4,999)
- "Merry-Go-Round Mastermind" Tier (Donations of \$5,000 and above)

Donor Benefits:

- Recognition in a district-wide press release
- Personalized thank you note signed by the School Committee, Superintendent, and School Principal
- Name on a plaque at the playground entrance
- Invitation to the playground ribbon-cutting

Date Submitted: January 4, 2024

Date Requested to be on the Agenda: January 8, 2024

Mayor suggested leaving who gets mentioned on the donor sign open ended depending on certain criteria.

The Superintendent informed the Committee that they are creating a playground account with the business office to track and ensure donations go directly to the playground.

Motion to approve as amended by adding #4 the playground committee will determine a date when donors will appear on the sign (sign NOT plaque) by Member Graham, second by Member Ruseau - 7/0 approved

- Member Ruseau will provide wording for the sign

Motion for a dedication to Emily Oliveira at the McGlynn inclusive playground with a sign by Member McLaughlin, second by Member Graham - 7/0 approved

X. Reports Requested - None

XI. Condolences

The Members of the Medford School Committee express their sincerest condolences to the family of **Judith Granara**, retired elementary school teacher for the Medford Public Schools. Mrs. Granara was the wife of former School Committee Member and State Representative Attorney John R. Granara and was a cousin of former Mayor Michael J. McGlynn.

The Members of the Medford School Committee express their sincerest condolences to the family of **Ernest A. Ardolino, Sr.**, former head coach of Medford High School Girls Basketball Team, former assistant coach of the High School Football Team and longtime Babe Ruth baseball coach.

The Members of the Medford School Committee express their sincerest condolences to the family of **Michael Jay Hamilton**, father of Medford High School Assistant Principal Patric Hamilton.

The Members of the Medford School Committee express their sincerest condolences to the family of **Patricia M. (Walsh) Dever**, mother of Michelle Kingdon, former Comptroller for Medford Public Schools.

The Members of the Medford School Committee express their sincerest condolences to the family of **Anthony Milli**, father of Debbie Donnarouma a former kindergarten aide at the Brooks School and currently works at the Brooks morning program.

XII. Next Meeting

January 29, 2024 - Alden Memorial Chambers, Medford City Hall in addition to zoom

XIII. Adjournment

Motion to Adjourn by Member McLaughlin, second by Member Graham - 7/0 approved
Meeting adjourned at 7:45 pm